RESOLUTION No. 7302

Resolution to Change the Name of Jason Lee Elementary School

RECITALS

A. Portland Public Schools acknowledges that the name of a school building has a significant impact on the overall educational environment and can foster positive student development and sense of belonging.
B. In May 2023, a group of parents initiated a request to change the name of Jason Lee Elementary, gathering over 70 signatures from students, staff, and community members in support of renaming the school.
C. In March 2024,the Board approved the request from the Jason Lee community, and directed the Superintendent to begin a renaming process that was grounded in community engagement, student voice, and alignment to Board policy.
D. A Renaming Committee was formed, composed of students, staff, parents, and community members. The committee met regularly over the course of two years to design and implement a process that centered on inclusivity, transparency, and meaningful engagement across the school community.
E. Ultimately, Sunrise Elementary School received the highest level of support from the community. The name “Sunrise” reflects themes of renewal, hope, and new beginnings, and was identified by the community as a symbol that represents both the current identity of the school and its aspirations for the future.
F. The Superintendent, having reviewed the process and work of the committee, recommends the Board of Education renames Jason Lee Elementary School to Sunrise Elementary School.

RESOLVED

NOW, THEREFORE, the Portland Public Schools Board of Education approves the Superintendent and school community’s final recommendation of Sunrise Elementary School, and Jason Lee Elementary School will be known as Sunrise Elementary School.